

Middle East Daily Brief

July 4, 2026

Executive summary

20 stories from 7 outlets (5 perspectives) over the reporting window. Leading the day: Khamenei lies in state in Tehran as Iran begins week of mass funeral ceremonies.

Top stories

1. **Khamenei lies in state in Tehran as Iran begins week of mass funeral ceremonies** *Al Jazeera, Arab News, CNN, Middle East Eye, Reuters, The Jerusalem Post, The Times of Israel* · corroborated by 7 outlets The body of slain Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei, killed in a joint US-Israeli strike on February 28, arrived at Tehran's Grand Mosalla to lie in state for three days as Iran opened a week of funeral ceremonies running July 4-9 across... <https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2026/7/3/iran-begins-week-of-funeral-ceremonies-for-slain-supreme-leader-khamenei>
2. **Mourners bury Damascus cafe blast victims as ministry says shrapnel-packed device caused attack** *Arab News, ABC News, Al Arabiya, Al Jazeera, Euronews* · corroborated by 5 outlets Damascus buried victims of Thursday's bombing at a cafe near the capital's main judicial complex as officials promised justice; reported tolls rose to as many as 9-10 dead and about 20 wounded. Syria's interior ministry said preliminary... <https://www.arabnews.com/node/2649545/middle-east>
3. **Netanyahu and Trump speak by phone, agree to meet in US soon** *The Times of Israel, Arab News* · corroborated by 2 outlets PM Netanyahu and President Trump spoke by phone and agreed to meet in the US in the near future, the Prime Minister's Office said. Netanyahu congratulated Trump on the 250th anniversary of America's founding; the call comes amid US-Iran... https://www.timesofisrael.com/liveblog_entry/trump-and-netanyahu-speak-by-phone-pmo-says-agreed-to-meet-in-us-soon/
4. **Settler attack injures several Palestinians near Hebron** *Middle East Eye, Middle East Monitor* · corroborated by 2 outlets Several Palestinians were injured in an attack by Israeli settlers near Hebron in the occupied West Bank, amid a wider pattern of settler violence; the Israeli army also dispersed a protest against a settlement outpost near Bethlehem,... <https://www.middleeasteye.net/live-blog/live-blog-update/settler-attack-injures-several-palestinians-near-hebron>
5. **Trump says Iran has agreed to 'just about everything' US needs as talks pause for funeral** *Al Arabiya, CBS News* · corroborated by 2 outlets President Trump told CNBC that Iran has 'agreed to just about everything we need' following the latest round of indirect talks in Doha. Negotiations are paused during the week of Khamenei funeral ceremonies, with the next round expected... <https://english.alarabiya.net/News/middle-east/2026/07/03/trump-says-iran-agrees-to-just-about-everything-us-needs>
6. **IDF and Shin Bet kill Hamas commander who abducted Cpt. Daniel Perez and held hostages** *The Jerusalem Post, The Times of Israel* · corroborated by 2 outlets The IDF and Shin Bet said

they killed Muhammad Na'im Jandiya, head of military security for Hamas's Shajaiyah Battalion, who participated in the October 7 abduction of tank officer Cpt. Daniel Perez and held hostages in Gaza. <https://www.jpost.com/israel-news/defense-news/article-901323>

By theme

Israel – Gaza & the Palestinians

- **Settler attack injures several Palestinians near Hebron** – Middle East Eye, Middle East Monitor <https://www.middleeasteye.net/live-blog/live-blog-update/settler-attack-injures-several-palestinians-near-hebron>
- **IDF and Shin Bet kill Hamas commander who abducted Cpt. Daniel Perez and held hostages** – The Jerusalem Post, The Times of Israel <https://www.jpost.com/israel-news/defense-news/article-901323>
- **Palestinian Foreign Ministry denies asking South Africa to withdraw ICJ case against Israel** – Middle East Monitor <https://www.middleeastmonitor.com/20260703-palestinian-foreign-ministry-denies-claims-it-asked-south-africa-to-withdraw-icj-case-against-israel/>
- **Israel approves 13 new settlements as Palestinians warn of Jerusalem's further isolation** – Middle East Monitor <https://www.middleeastmonitor.com/20260703-israel-approves-13-new-illegal-settlements-as-palestinians-warn-of-jeruselems-further-isolation/>
- **In the West Bank, Israeli settlers take over a Palestinian family's dream home** – Arab News <https://www.arabnews.com/node/2649531/middle-east>
- **Israeli army confirms authenticity of image showing Palestinian detainee abused in Gaza** – Middle East Monitor <https://www.middleeastmonitor.com/20260703-israeli-army-confirms-authenticity-of-image-showing-palestinian-detainee-abused-in-gaza/>

Iran & the US

- **Khamenei lies in state in Tehran as Iran begins week of mass funeral ceremonies** – Al Jazeera, Arab News, CNN, Middle East Eye, Reuters, The Jerusalem Post, The Times of Israel <https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2026/7/3/iran-begins-week-of-funeral-ceremonies-for-slain-supreme-leader-khamenei>
- **Trump says Iran has agreed to 'just about everything' US needs as talks pause for funeral** – Al Arabiya, CBS News <https://english.alarabiya.net/News/middle-east/2026/07/03/trump-says-iran-agrees-to-just-about-everything-us-needs>
- **Foreign officials arrive for Khamenei funeral as IRGC general emerges from hiding and warns Israel, US against strikes** – The Jerusalem Post, The Times of Israel <https://www.jpost.com/middle-east/iran-news/2026-07-03/live-updates-901305>
- **'Extravagant ceremony for a dictator': Some Iranians say they will avoid Khamenei's funeral** – The Times of Israel <https://www.timesofisrael.com/extravagant-ceremony-for-a-dictator-some-iranians-will-avoid-khameneis-funeral>
- **China calls for 'proper settlement' to end disruptions in Strait of Hormuz** – Middle East Monitor <https://www.middleeastmonitor.com/20260703-china-calls-for-proper-settlement-to-end-disruptions-in-strait-of-hormuz/>

Lebanon & Hezbollah

- **UN human rights investigators begin ‘first of its kind’ mission in Lebanon** — Arab News <https://www.arabnews.com/node/2649600/middle-east>
- **Over 640,000 displaced Lebanese return home amid ceasefire, IOM says** — Arab News <https://www.arabnews.com/node/2649590/middle-east>
- **Israeli drone strikes injure 2 in southern Lebanon despite framework agreement** — Middle East Monitor <https://www.middleeastmonitor.com/20260703-israeli-drone-strikes-injure-2-in-southern-lebanon-despite-framework-agreement/>
- **France and Italy preparing new international force for southern Lebanon after UNIFIL** — Middle East Monitor <https://www.middleeastmonitor.com/20260703-france-italy-to-form-new-international-force-for-southern-lebanon/>

Syria & Iraq

- **Mourners bury Damascus cafe blast victims as ministry says shrapnel-packed device caused attack** — Arab News, ABC News, Al Arabiya, Al Jazeera, Euronews <https://www.arabnews.com/node/2649541/middle-east>

Egypt & North Africa

- **Exclusive: ICC prosecutors shelved RSF arrest warrant as Sudan atrocities mounted** — Middle East Eye <https://www.middleeasteye.net/news/exclusive-icc-prosecutors-shelved-rsf-arrest-warrant-atrocities-mounted>

Israel – politics & society

- **Netanyahu and Trump speak by phone, agree to meet in US soon** — The Times of Israel, Arab News https://www.timesofisrael.com/liveblog_entry/trump-and-netanyahu-speak-by-phone-pmo-says-agreed-to-meet-in-us-soon/
- **Lebanon’s Aoun defends trilateral agreement, says it ‘does not legitimize’ Israeli military presence** — The Times of Israel https://www.timesofisrael.com/liveblog_entry/lebanons-aoun-defends-trilateral-agreement-says-it-does-not-legitimize-idf-presence/

Other regional news

- **Outrage after Turkish stand-up comedian arrested for ‘insulting’ Erdogan** — Middle East Eye <https://www.middleeasteye.net/news/outrage-after-turkish-stand-comedian-arrest-insulting-erdogan>

Perspective balance

Perspective	Stories
pro-Palestinian	6
Israeli	5
Saudi	5
independent	3

Perspective	Stories
Qatari	1

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